again. That way, Rahul Gandhi's instincts to spearhead ideological work are correct. The BJY was step one (which yielded success). If the Congress wants to keep tasting success, it follows that it needs to escalate ideological and social work (not as periodic events but consistently and patiently).

From a Party to a Movement

In early 2019, I had written about the need for the Congress to shift gears from being a political party to being a movement that could mobilize a counter-narrative beyond immediate electoral calculations. A movement-type mobilization demonstrates a different kind of resolve and purpose. It is invested in deep commitment, and the BJY came to precisely reflect this kind of resolve in the energies it galvanized. The sheer prospect of walking for close to 4,000 kilometres symbolized the gravity of the situation and the commitment to listen and learn from common people. Mancur Olson, in his work *The Logic of Collective Action*, suggests that collective action always requires intangible factors more than cost–benefit reasoning. Olson asked why workers joined a struggle for better wages even when they knew that if better wages were granted, everyone would benefit, irrespective of the fact that he or she had joined the movement. This is why he says there needs to be something more—a 'zing' thing—beyond rational calculations.

The BJY brought this forth. It raised an abstract idea of love that needs to be foregrounded in the context of a growing sense of depravity and hate. This brought immediate relief to scores of religious minorities and social activists who felt targeted. It was, at least to begin with, a sincere attempt to change the narrative and remind us of a different sensibility we once had. In spite of poor media coverage, the BJY grabbed eyeballs. It created excitement as to whether or not it would succeed in creating a new pan-India mood. Most of the response was spontaneous, beyond what was organized by the Congress party (for which it had to specially deploy select Congress stakeholders in each state to reach out to non-political forces. While these select stakeholders were successful beyond their own